

ENDORISING POWER

The concerted efforts of the Shivraj Singh Chouhan government have enabled the generation capacity of Madhya Pradesh go up by 2742 MW — a whopping growth of 92 per cent on the installed capacity of 2003. The power capacity is soon to be increased by another 400 MW with the transmission capacity rising by 44 per cent. A report.

- Power worth Rs 2,000 crore has been purchased by the state in the last three years, quite in contrast with power purchase of Rs 344 crore between January '99 and December '03;
- Better and regular maintenance of transformers has reduced the rate of breakdowns by seven per cent;
- The state has signed MOUs for production of 12,000 MW with the private sector, with a view to augment power production. Full co-operation has also been extended to Sasan Ultramega Power Project in district Sidhi.

The government of Madhya Pradesh seems to have taken an oath to light up every house of the state in next to no time. Or so it seems owing to the innumerable tasks being undertaken for power transmission in the state, of late.

The four years' tenure of the Shivraj Singh Chouhan government has witnessed praiseworthy growth in power transmission in the state of Madhya Pradesh as compared to the earlier 10 years. Commendable improvement has been recorded in power transmission in the preceding four years as weighed against the period between 1993-94 and 2003-04. The state government has prioritised the consolidation of the transmission system and the implementation of many power boosting projects. The efforts of the government bore fruit last year with the transmission capacity rising to 6,493 MW in comparison to 3,890 MW in 2002-03. Now the state government aims to increase it to 8,170 MW in 2008-09.

■ FURTHERMORE -

- Where the figure related to the establishment of sub-stations stagnated at 27 during the preceding period of 10 years, as many as 41 sub-stations have been set up in the last four years.
- The transmission network has further been strengthened by placing 3,611 circuit kilometers of transmission lines of 400 KV, 200KV and 132 KV in the last three years.

- The capacity of transformers at high-tension sub-stations has been improved up to 7,480 MVA in the last four years while the 10 years preceding the mentioned years recorded the augmented capacity of just 6,942 MVA.

Annual Comparison of Total Power Supply (Million units) with Maximum Demand (MW)

Year	Power Supply (Million Units)	Maximum Demand (MW)
2001-02	26438	4632
2002-03	27094	4652
2003-04	28599	4984
2004-05	30574	5241
2005-06	32232	5780
2006-07	33435	6109
2007-08	37081 (expected)	6501

Indubitably, all these developments in the power sector were possible because of the go-getting attitude and untiring indefatigable efforts of the enthused government of the Chief Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan.

AWARDS & ACCOLADES

- The Prime Minister conferred the Second Best Executed Power Project National Award to MP Power Transmission Company for year 2004-2005;
- The state's transmission company won 'Utility of the year 2006' and 'T & P Project of the year' awards, instituted by Asian Power magazine.
- Indotech Foundation also conferred award to the state for Reforms in Power Sector.

■ SUBSIDISING GROWTH

Rural electrification seems to be one of the foremost concerns of the state government. Subsidy of Rs 534 crore has been given to save powerloom consumers and farmers from the burden of increase in power tariff by the Electricity Regulatory Authority in April 2007. Tariff subsidies worth Rs 1798 crores were also paid to the Board. To bridge the gap between demand and supply, the power purchase has enhanced manifold.

